

HOME ENERGY ASSISTANCE PROGRAM APPLICATION

PLEASE READ THE INSTRUCTIONS ATTACHED TO THE BACK OF THE APPLICATION. ANSWER ALL QUESTIONS. DO NOT WRITE IN THE SHADED AREAS. PLEASE PRINT CLEARLY AND SIGN THE FORM ON PAGE 5. COMPLETE THE WHITE BOXES BELOW IN BLUE OR BLACK INK.

CONTACT THE AGENCY ABOVE IF YOU NEED HELP					AGENCY USE ONLY			
					DSS		OFA/ALTERNATE CERTIFIER	
					DATE RECEIVED		DATE RECEIVED	
AGENCY USE ONLY								
APPLICATION DATE	OFFICE	UNIT ID	WORKER ID	CASE TYPE	CASE NUMBER	REGISTRY NUMBER	VERS.	
CASE NAME					☐ REGULAR	☐ HEATING EQPT	☐ COOLING	
					☐ EMERGENCY	☐ CLEAN & TUNE	☐ OTHER _____	

SECTION 1: HOUSEHOLD COMPOSITION

APPLICANT INFORMATION												
FIRST NAME				MI	LAST NAME							
OTHER NAMES BY WHICH I HAVE BEEN KNOWN ARE:				OTHER NAME				OTHER NAME				
CURRENT STREET ADDRESS						APT. #	CITY					
STATE	ZIP CODE		COUNTY		LENGTH OF TIME AT THIS ADDRESS? YEARS _____ MONTHS _____							
DAYTIME PHONE NUMBER WHERE I CAN BE REACHED (Area Code + Phone No.)					BEST TIME TO CALL		IF AN INTERVIEW IS NEEDED, I WOULD LIKE A: ☐ Phone Interview ☐ In Person Interview					
MY MAILING ADDRESS (IF DIFFERENT FROM ABOVE) IS:												
ADDRESS				APT. #	CITY			COUNTY	STATE	ZIP CODE		
HAVE YOU EVER APPLIED FOR HEAP? ☐ YES ☐ NO										IF YES, ENTER DATE OF MOST RECENT APPLICATION ➡		
LIST EVERYONE INCLUDING YOURSELF WHO CURRENTLY LIVES IN THE SAME HOUSE (If no one else, write NONE UNDER YOUR NAME):												
CD	LN	FIRST NAME	MI	LAST NAME	DATE OF BIRTH			SEX	GENDER IDENTITY (Optional) Male, Female, Non-Binary, X, Transgender, Different Identity (Please describe)	RELATION TO ME	SOCIAL SECURITY NUMBER	CITIZEN / NATIONAL OR QUALIFIED ALIEN
					MO.	DAY	YR.	M/F				
1	01									SELF		☐ YES ☐ NO
1	02											☐ YES ☐ NO
1	03											☐ YES ☐ NO
1	04											☐ YES ☐ NO
1	05											☐ YES ☐ NO
1	06											☐ YES ☐ NO
If there are more members in your household, please attach a separate sheet of paper.										Total Number in Household: _____		
Is anyone in your household blind or disabled? ☐ YES ☐ NO If yes, who? _____												
DO YOU OR DOES ANYONE LIVING AT YOUR ADDRESS GET OR HAVE RECENTLY APPLIED FOR SUPPLEMENTAL NUTRITION ASSISTANCE PROGRAM (SNAP)? ☐ YES ☐ NO If yes, who? _____ CASE NUMBER _____												
DO YOU OR DOES ANYONE LIVING AT YOUR ADDRESS GET OR HAVE RECENTLY APPLIED FOR TEMPORARY ASSISTANCE? ☐ YES ☐ NO If yes, who? _____ CASE NUMBER _____												

SECTION 2: HOUSING – CHECK (✓) ONE BOX ONLY**HOMEOWNER**

- ☐ Single Family House or Mobile Home
☐ Multi-Family House; List Number of Units _____
☐ Co-op/Condo Owner
☐ Life Estate/Use

OTHER

- ☐ I live with someone else and share expenses
☐ I pay for a room
☐ I pay room and board
☐ Permanent hotel/motel
☐ Other living situation _____

RENTER

- ☐ Private House, Apartment or Mobile Home

SUBSIDIZED RENT

- ☐ Private Subsidized Housing
☐ Public Housing Project or Senior Housing
☐ Public Subsidized Housing

Do you receive a HUD utility allowance?

- ☐ Yes If yes, how much \$ _____ ☐ No

MY MONTHLY RENT OR MORTGAGE PAYMENT IS:

\$ _____ ☐ NONE

IF APPLICABLE, THE NAME OF THE APARTMENT BUILDING OR HOUSING PROJECT I LIVE IN IS:

DO YOU OR DOES ANYONE IN YOUR HOUSEHOLD RECEIVE A SENIOR CITIZEN RENT INCREASE EXEMPTION (SCRIE)?

- ☐ YES ☐ NO

SECTION 3: HEAT AND UTILITY INFORMATION

1. DO YOU PAY SEPARATELY FOR HEAT? ☐ Yes- Complete information below ☐ No

My main source of heat is

- ☐ Natural Gas ☐ Fuel Oil ☐ Electric ☐ Coal or Corn
☐ Wood/Wood Pellets ☐ Kerosene ☐ Propane or Bottle Gas ☐ Other _____

My fuel tank is: ☐ Individual Tank ☐ Metered Tank

Is the heating bill in your name? ☐ YES ☐ NO

If No, name on the bill: _____ Relationship to you: _____

Are you directly responsible to pay the bill? ☐ YES ☐ NO

Your heating company's name is: _____

Your Heating Company's Address: _____

Your heating account number is: _____

2. DO YOU PAY A SEPARATE ELECTRIC BILL FOR UTILITIES OTHER THAN HEAT?

- ☐ YES – Complete information below ☐ NO

If yes, is the electric bill in your name? ☐ YES ☐ NO If No, name on the bill _____

Your electric account number (if you have one) is: _____

Your utility company's name is: _____

Is electric necessary to run the furnace? ☐ YES ☐ NO

Is electricity necessary to operate the thermostat in your apartment? ☐ YES ☐ NO

3. ARE BOTH HEAT AND ELECTRIC INCLUDED IN YOUR RENT? ☐ YES ☐ NO

SECTION 4: HOUSEHOLD INCOME

REPORT ANY INCOME FOR **ALL HOUSEHOLD MEMBERS**. ALL AMOUNTS MUST BE REPORTED AS **GROSS MONTHLY INCOME** BEFORE ANY DEDUCTIONS. ATTACH ADDITIONAL SHEETS IF NECESSARY.

CHECK YES OR NO FOR EACH (✓)	TYPE OF INCOME	IF YES, GIVE AMOUNT	ADDITIONAL INFORMATION	WHO RECEIVES?
☐ YES ☐ NO	SOCIAL SECURITY AMOUNT BEFORE MEDICARE PART B & D	GROSS MONTHLY AMOUNT \$	Indicate amount you pay for : Medicare Part B: Medicare Part D:	
☐ YES ☐ NO	SOCIAL SECURITY DISABILITY AMOUNT BEFORE MEDICARE PART B & D	GROSS MONTHLY AMOUNT \$	Indicate amount you pay for : Medicare Part B: Medicare Part D:	
☐ YES ☐ NO	SUPPLEMENTAL SECURITY INCOME (SSI)	GROSS MONTHLY AMOUNT \$		
☐ YES ☐ NO	WAGES SUBMIT WAGE STUBS FOR THE PAST 4 WEEKS. Note: Gross Weekly amounts are multiplied by 4.333333 to calculate the monthly amount. Gross Bi-Weekly amounts are multiplied by 2.166666 to calculate the monthly amount.	☐ WEEKLY \$ ☐ BI-WEEKLY \$ ☐ MONTHLY \$ ☐ SEMI-MONTHLY	Employer	
		☐ WEEKLY \$ ☐ BI-WEEKLY \$ ☐ MONTHLY \$ ☐ SEMI-MONTHLY	Employer	
		☐ WEEKLY \$ ☐ BI-WEEKLY \$ ☐ MONTHLY \$ ☐ SEMI-MONTHLY	Employer	
		☐ WEEKLY \$ ☐ BI-WEEKLY \$ ☐ MONTHLY \$ ☐ SEMI-MONTHLY	Employer	
☐ YES ☐ NO	PENSION/RETIREMENT Private and/or government	GROSS MONTHLY AMOUNT \$	Source of Pension	
☐ YES ☐ NO	VETERAN'S BENEFITS	GROSS MONTHLY AMOUNT \$		
☐ YES ☐ NO	DISABILITY private or NYS	GROSS WEEKLY AMOUNT \$	Source	
☐ YES ☐ NO	CONTRIBUTION from someone outside the household	GROSS MONTHLY AMOUNT \$	Name of Contributor	
☐ YES ☐ NO	CHILD SUPPORT	GROSS WEEKLY AMOUNT \$	Source	
☐ YES ☐ NO	ALIMONY/SPOUSAL SUPPORT including payments for mortgage, utility bills, etc.	GROSS MONTHLY AMOUNT \$	Source	
☐ YES ☐ NO	RENTAL INCOME apartment, garage, land, etc.	GROSS MONTHLY AMOUNT \$	Type of Rental	
☐ YES ☐ NO	ROOM/BOARD (received) etc.	GROSS MONTHLY AMOUNT \$	Name of Room/Boarder	
☐ YES ☐ NO	WORKER'S COMPENSATION	GROSS WEEKLY AMOUNT \$		
☐ YES ☐ NO	UNEMPLOYMENT BENEFITS	GROSS WEEKLY AMOUNT \$	Start Date: End Date:	
☐ YES ☐ NO	Income from savings, checking, CDs, money market accounts, stocks, bonds, securities. IRA, annuity, and 401K distributions.	ENTER INFORMATION ON NEXT PAGE		
☐ YES ☐ NO	IS THERE ANY OTHER INCOME FROM ANY OTHER SOURCE? ATTACH EXPLANATION	AMOUNT \$	Source	WHO RECEIVES
☐ YES ☐ NO	SELF-EMPLOYMENT INCOME _____ TYPE OF BUSINESS _____ If yes, you may choose to have your self-employment income calculated based on your filed federal tax return for the current year or prior tax year if you have not yet filed for the current year, including all applicable schedules or based on the three (3) months prior to your application. Please choose one method: ☐ Filed Federal Tax Return ☐ Three Months			

IS THERE ANYONE IN YOUR HOUSEHOLD AGE 18 OR OLDER WHO **DOES NOT** HAVE ANY INCOME FROM ANY SOURCE?

☐ YES, list members with no income: ☐ NO

IS THERE ANYONE IN YOUR HOUSEHOLD WHO IS A FULL-TIME DEPENDENT HIGH SCHOOL OR COLLEGE STUDENT?

☐ YES, list member(s): ☐ NO

INTEREST AND INVESTMENT INCOME

LIST EACH ACCOUNT SEPARATELY. ATTACH ADDITIONAL SHEETS IF NECESSARY.	AMOUNT RECEIVED YEAR-TO-DATE	SOURCE
INTEREST from savings, checking, CDs, money market accounts, etc.	\$	Name of Bank
INTEREST from savings, checking, CDs, money market accounts, etc.	\$	Name of Bank
INTEREST from savings, checking, CDs, money market accounts, etc.	\$	Name of Bank
INTEREST from savings, checking, CDs, money market accounts, etc.	\$	Name of Bank
DIVIDENDS from stocks, bonds, securities, etc.	\$	Source of Dividends
DIVIDENDS from stocks, bonds, securities, etc.	\$	Source of Dividends
DIVIDENDS from stocks, bonds, securities, etc.	\$	Source of Dividends
DIVIDENDS from stocks, bonds, securities, etc.	\$	Source of Dividends
DISTRIBUTIONS from IRA, 401K, annuity, etc.	\$	Source of Distributions
DISTRIBUTIONS from IRA, 401K, annuity, etc.	\$	Source of Distributions
DISTRIBUTIONS from IRA, 401K, annuity, etc.	\$	Source of Distributions

AUTHORIZED REPRESENTATIVE

You can designate someone who knows your household circumstances to be your authorized representative. Your Authorized Representative may: complete and file your HEAP application, contact the agency and speak with your worker, have access to eligibility information in your case file, complete all forms for you, provide documentation, appeal agency decisions. You must still sign this application. The Authorized Representative designation will remain in effect for the current HEAP season unless revoked by you. Each HEAP season you will be asked if you want to designate an Authorized Representative.

I would like to designate an authorized representative. ☐ YES - Complete information below ☐ NO

Name of authorized representative:

Address and phone number:

PLEASE SIGN APPLICATION ON PAGE 5

SECTION 5: IMPORTANT NOTICES**IMPORTANT NOTICE**

YOU SHOULD BE AWARE THAT THERE IS LIMITED MONEY AVAILABLE FOR HEAP BENEFIT PAYMENTS. ONCE AVAILABLE MONEY IS EXHAUSTED, NO BENEFITS WILL BE ISSUED. THEREFORE, IT IS STRONGLY RECOMMENDED THAT YOU COMPLETE AND SUBMIT YOUR APPLICATION AS SOON AS POSSIBLE.

PERSONAL PRIVACY LAW - NOTIFICATION TO CLIENTS

The State's Personal Privacy Protection Law, which took effect September 1, 1984, states that we must tell you what the State will do with the information you give us about yourself and your family. We use the information to find out if you are eligible for the Home Energy Assistance Program and, if so, for how much. The section of the Law that gives us the right to collect the information about you is Section 21 of the Social Services Law. To make sure that you are getting all of the assistance you and your family are legally entitled to receive, we check with other sources to find out more about the information you have given us. For example:

- We may check to find out if you or anyone in your household were working. We do this by sending your name and Social Security Number to the State Department of Taxation and Finance, and also to known employers, to tell us whether you worked and, if so, how much you made.
- We may ask the State to check with the Unemployment Insurance Division to see if you or anyone in your household were getting unemployment benefits.
- We may check with banks to make sure we know about any income you or anyone in your household may have received.

Besides using the information you give us in this way, the State also uses the information to prepare statistics about all the people receiving Home Energy Assistance. This information is used for program planning and management. The information is used for quality control by the State to make sure local districts are doing the best job they can. It is used to verify who your energy supplier is and to make certain payments to such vendors. Your failure to provide us with the information we need may prevent us from finding out if you are eligible for assistance and we may then have to deny your application. This information is kept by the Commissioner, Office of Temporary and Disability Assistance, 40 North Pearl Street, Albany, New York 12243-0001. Do not send your application to this address. If you or anyone in your household does not have a Social Security Number, a Social Security Number must be applied for at the U.S. Social Security Administration.

Read the Important Information Below

I swear and/or affirm that the information given on this application and subsequent phone interviews is true and correct. I realize that any false statements or other misrepresentation knowingly made by me in connection with this application and subsequent requests for HEAP assistance may result in my being found ineligible for the assistance paid to me or on my behalf. Additionally, any false statement or misrepresentation knowingly made by me for purposes of obtaining assistance under this program may result in an action against me which may subject me to civil and/or criminal penalties.

CONSENT

I understand that by signing this application/certification, I consent to any investigation to verify or confirm the information I have given and other investigation by any authorized government agency in connection with this and any other requests for Home Energy Assistance Program (HEAP) benefits. I also consent to allow the information provided on this application to be used in referrals to available weatherization assistance programs and my utility company's low income programs.

I understand that the State will use my Social Security Number to verify with my home energy vendors the receipt of HEAP. This authorization also includes permission for any of my home energy vendors (including my utility) to release certain statistical information, including but not limited to, my electricity usage, electricity cost, fuel consumption, fuel type, annual fuel cost and payment history to the Office of Temporary and Disability Assistance, the local Social Services District and the United States Department of Health and Human Services for the purposes of Low Income Home Energy Assistance Program (LIHEAP) performance measurement.

TO GET HEAP- ALL QUESTIONS MUST BE ANSWERED AND YOUR APPLICATION MUST BE SIGNED AND DATED BELOW.**SIGN HERE:**

DATE SIGNED

X

NAME OF PERSON, IF ANY, WHO ASSISTED YOU:

PHONE NUMBER:

AGENCY USE ONLY			
APPLICATION TYPE: ☐ Full Documentation ☐ Simplified			
Vendor	Account Number	Vendor Code	Vendor Relationship: ☐ Current Bill/Vendor Statement ☐ Collateral Contact
IDENTITY OF HOUSEHOLD MEMBERS			
LN	HOUSEHOLD MEMBER'S NAME	DOCUMENTATION	
01			
02			
03			
04			
05			
06			
IS ANYONE IN THE HOUSEHOLD VULNERABLE? ☐ Under the age of 6 ☐ Age 60 or older ☐ Permanently Disabled			
Who _____ Documentation _____			
RESIDENCE – CHECK TYPE OF DOCUMENTATION OBTAINED			
☐ Current Rent Receipt w/Name & Address ☐ Water, Sewage, or Tax Bill ☐ Mortgage Payment Book/Receipts w/Address ☐ Homeowner's/Renter's Insurance Policy ☐ Copy of Lease w/Address ☐ Utility Bill ☐ Other _____			
INCOME DOCUMENTATION/CALCULATION		Categorically Eligible: ☐ TA ☐ SNAP ☐ Code A SSI	
Comments, resolution activities, income calculation/documentation, verification of emergency for expedited regular benefit, vendor contract, etc. SHOW ALL CALCULATIONS Gross Bi-Weekly Income x 2.166666 Gross Weekly Income x 4.333333		REGULAR BENEFIT (EMERGENCY USE PART B) ☐ SEPARATE HEAT (check one) ☐ Oil ☐ Kerosene ☐ LP Gas ☐ Natural Gas ☐ Wood ☐ Wood Pellets ☐ Coal/Corn ☐ PSC Electric ☐ Municipal Electric ☐ HEAT INCLUDED IN RENT ☐ Payment to Household ☐ Payment to Utility	
TOTAL INCOME \$		Benefit \$ _____	
☐ Application compared to previous information ☐ No prior application ☐ No Changes ☐ WMS Inquiry ☐ Changes verified How: _____			
☐ Pended	START: _____	END: _____	☐ APPROVED ☐ DENIED
CERTIFYING AGENCY _____			
WORKER'S SIGNATURE/DATE _____			
SUPERVISOR'S SIGNATURE/DATE _____			
CONSENT TO WITHDRAW			
Only sign here if you want to withdraw your application and not to apply for HEAP.			
I CONSENT TO WITHDRAW MY APPLICATION		SIGN HERE X _____	
I UNDERSTAND THAT I MAY REAPPLY FOR HEAP BENEFITS AT ANY TIME DURING THE PERIOD THAT HEAP APPLICATIONS ARE BEING ACCEPTED			

AGENCY USE ONLY

NOTES AND INCOME CALCULATION WORKSHEET

FEDERAL REPORTING STATUS OF HOME ENERGY SERVICE

THE HOUSEHOLD HAS ONE OR MORE OF THE FOLLOWING - CHECK ALL THAT APPLY

- ☐ A disconnect notice. Company Name: _____
- ☐ Disconnection from service. Company Name: _____
- ☐ Less than $\frac{1}{4}$ tank of fuel. Company Name: _____
- ☐ Less than a 10 day supply of fuel. Company Name: _____
- ☐ Out of fuel. Company Name: _____
- ☐ A non-working furnace/boiler/heat system that needs replacement
- ☐ Electricity as supplemented heating fuel.
- ☐ Wood as supplemental heating fuel.
- ☐ Other supplemental heating fuel.
- ☐ Central air conditioning.
- ☐ A window or wall air conditioner.

INSTRUCTIONS FOR COMPLETING THE APPLICATION:

Complete all non-shaded areas and answer all questions.

Who should complete and sign the application?

The application should be completed by the person who has primary and direct responsibility for payment of the heating bill or the primary tenant if heat is included in the rent.

What address should I list?

You must list your current address. This must be your permanent and primary residence.

Why do you need my daytime phone number?

It is important to list a phone number where you can be reached. This will assist in timely processing of your application if additional information is required.

Will I need an interview?

Some applicants may be required to have an interview. You may choose to have a phone interview or to have an in person interview. Please indicate your interview preference in the box on page one. Completion of this section does not mean you will be required to have an interview.

All applications for heating equipment repair or replacement must have an in person interview.

Who should I list as household members?

List everyone who lives in your house, even if they are not related to you or contributing financially to your household. You may be required to provide proof of identity for all household members. List yourself first on line 1. If you live alone, write the word "none" on line 2.

Gender Identity

New York State ensures your right to access State benefits and/or services regardless of sex, gender identity or expression. You must report your sex and the sex of all household members as male or female. The sex you report here must be the same as what is currently on file with the United States Social Security Administration. The sex you report is needed to process your application. It will not appear on any benefit card you may receive or any other public-facing document.

Gender identity is how you perceive yourself and what you call yourself. Your gender identity can be the same as or different from your sex assigned at birth. Gender identity is not required for this application. If your gender identity, or the gender identity of anyone in your household, is different than the sex you report for that person and you would like to provide that person's gender identity, print "Male", "Female", "Non-Binary", "X", "Transgender", or "Different Identity" in the space provided. If you print "Different Identity", you may choose to describe that person's gender identity further in the space provided.

Citizen /Alien Information:

In order to receive HEAP, you must be a U.S. citizen, Qualified Alien, or U.S. non-citizen national. For additional information on what constitutes a Qualified Alien or U.S. non-citizen national, please contact the New York State Office of Temporary and Disability Assistance hotline at 1-800-342-3009 or visit the OTDA website at <http://www.otda.ny.gov>.

Why do I need to provide Social Security numbers for everyone?

Social Security numbers are required for all household members. The information is validated with data from the Social Security Administration. If any member does not have a Social Security number but has applied for one, write the word "applied" in the Social Security Number box. If you leave this section blank for any household member, your application cannot be processed but will be pended for further information. This information may also be used to perform data matches with other state and federal agencies for the purposes of verifying your household's HEAP eligibility.

Housing Information

Please check the box that most accurately represents your housing situation.

Heating Situation

Make sure to answer all three (3) questions

How should I complete the income section? Will I need to provide proof?

List ALL income for all household members. All amounts should be entered as gross income prior to any deductions. Deductions include, but are not limited to: income taxes, child support, garnishments, health insurance, and union dues. You are required to submit documentation of all earned income, including self-employment and rental income. You may be required to provide proof of other income. Please see page 6 of the application instructions for specific types of acceptable documentation. Do not submit originals, they will not be returned. Eligibility will be based on your household's gross monthly income for the month of application.

Please enter the amount of your Social Security before any deductions for Medicare. List separately the amounts that you pay for Medicare Part B and/or D. Amounts for Medicare Parts B and D are excluded as income.

Enter only the interest or dividend portions of bank accounts, CDs, stocks, bonds or other investment income. List each account separately. If you need more space, attach additional sheets. Enter the amount received for the year to date.

What does authorized representative mean?

An authorized representative is a person who may act as your agent for HEAP purposes as listed on the application. Authorized representative status is for the current program only and you may revoke it at any time during the program by submitting a statement to your local Social Services District. Since this person may be providing information on your behalf, it should be someone who knows your circumstances.

Make sure to SIGN and date the application. The application must be signed by the person who has the heating bill in their name, or who pays the bill if it is in someone else's name. If heat is included in the rent, the primary tenant must complete and sign the application.

Motor Voter Registration

Please include the Motor Voter form with your application. Complete this form if you are not registered to vote and you want to register. This does not affect your HEAP eligibility or benefit amount.

WHAT WILL I NEED TO APPLY?

New applicants will need to include the following documentation along with your application:

- Proof of each household member's identity
- A valid Social Security Number for each household member
- Proof of residence
- A fuel and/or utility bill if you pay for heat or proof that you pay rent which includes heat
- Documentation of income for all household members

Please see page 6 of the application instructions for specific types of acceptable documentation. In addition, new applicants will also need to have an interview; and you can choose either a phone interview or an in person interview. However, if you do choose a phone interview, please include a working phone number and the best time to contact you for a phone interview on Page 1 of your application.

All applications for heating equipment repair or replacement must be in person with full documentation.

WHERE TO APPLY:

You must apply in the county in which you currently reside. You can apply in person or mail in your application at the address stamped at the top of the application or can find other local certifiers by checking our website at: <http://www.otda.ny.gov>.

MY BENEFITS

You may apply for HEAP online by going to <https://www.mybenefits.ny.gov> . Once your application for HEAP is submitted, you can check the status of your application on-line by using your secure online account at <https://www.mybenefits.ny.gov> . If your application is approved the amount of the benefit is provided. You may be eligible for food assistance. Check your eligibility and apply for SNAP at <https://www.mybenefits.ny.gov> . Additional information about HEAP and other human services programs can be found at <https://www.mybenefits.ny.gov> .

How will my benefit be paid?

If you are approved and you pay for heat, your payment will be sent to your heating fuel vendor. Your eligibility notice will include the name of the vendor. If the vendor listed is not correct, notify the local Social Services District immediately. In some cases, your benefit will be paid to your electric company if heat is included in your rent. Your notice will tell you the amount of the benefit, how it will be paid, and how it was calculated.

Vendors are not permitted to make deliveries until payment is received or until instructed to do so by the local Social Services District. Benefits may not be applied to prior deliveries for deliverable fuel sources. If you are in need of fuel before your vendor has received notification or payment, you must contact your local Social Services District.

Regular HEAP benefits are intended to be a one-time supplement to your annual energy costs and are not intended to replace your personal payments. You must continue to pay your energy bills.

What is a HEAP Emergency?

- You are out of fuel or have less than $\frac{1}{4}$ tank of oil, kerosene or propane, or less than a ten (10) day supply of other deliverable heating fuel.
- Your natural gas or electric heat has been shut off or is scheduled to be shut off.
- Applicant owned heating equipment is not working.

WHAT IF I HAVE AN EMERGENCY?

HEAP benefits can assist with the following emergencies:

- You are out of fuel or have less than $\frac{1}{4}$ tank of oil, kerosene or propane, or less than a ten (10) day supply of other deliverable heating fuel.
- Your natural gas or electric heat has been shut off or is scheduled to be shut off.
- Applicant owned heating equipment is not working.

If you have a heating emergency and have applied for, but have not received, your regular benefit, you should contact your local Social Services District after the program opens. Whenever possible, regular HEAP benefits are used first to resolve an energy emergency.

DO NOT WAIT UNTIL YOU ARE OUT OF HEATING FUEL OR YOUR GAS/ELECTRIC SERVICE IS OFF TO REQUEST ASSISTANCE. IF YOUR UTILITY SERVICE IS TERMINATED, YOUR UTILITY COMPANY IS NOT REQUIRED TO RESTORE YOUR SERVICE EVEN IF YOU ARE ELIGIBLE FOR A HEAP BENEFIT.

FAIR HEARINGS

You have certain rights when filing your HEAP application. You have the right to be told if your application is approved or denied within thirty (30) business days of the date that the HEAP certifier receives your completed and signed application.

The processing time for applications will not begin until program opening even though you may have received an application prior to the program opening date as a part of our outreach effort. You have the right to request a conference and/or a fair hearing if it has been more than thirty (30) business days since the HEAP certifier received your signed and completed application (or it has been more than thirty (30) business days since program opening if the certifier received your application prior to program opening) and you have not been told of the eligibility decision.

If you would like a conference, you should ask for one as soon as possible. At the conference, if it is discovered that a wrong decision was made, or if because of information you provide, the decision has changed our original decision, corrective action will be taken.

If you would like a conference, contact your local social services district at <http://otda.ny.gov/programs/heap/contacts>. This is only for requesting a conference. It is not how you ask for a fair hearing. If you ask for or have a conference, you are still entitled to a fair hearing.

The Office of Temporary and Disability Assistance (OTDA) policy issuances and manuals are posted on the OTDA website at otda.ny.gov/legal. These issuances and manuals are available to you or your representative to determine whether a fair hearing should be requested or to prepare for a fair hearing. In addition, upon request to your local social services district, specific OTDA policy issuances and manuals will also be available to assist you or your representative.

If you live anywhere in New York State, you may request a Fair Hearing by telephone, fax, online, or by writing to the address below:

Telephone: Statewide toll-free request number is 800-342-3334. Please have the notice, if any, with you when you call.

Fax: your Fair Hearing request to: 518-473-6735

Online: Complete online request form at <http://www.otda.ny.gov/oah/>

In writing: For notices, fill in the supplied space and send a copy of the notice, or write to:

NYS Office of Temporary and Disability Assistance
Office of Administrative Hearings
P.O. Box 1930
Albany, NY 12201-1930

If you request a fair hearing, NYS will send you a notice of the time and place of the hearing. You have the right to be represented by legal counsel, a relative, friend, or other person, or to represent yourself. At the hearing, your attorney or other representative will have the opportunity to present written and oral evidence, as well as the opportunity to question any persons who appear at the hearing. Also, you have the right to bring witnesses to speak in your favor. You should bring to the hearing any documents that may be helpful in presenting your case.

If you need free legal assistance, you may be able to obtain such assistance by contacting your local Legal Aid society or other legal advocate group. You may locate the nearest Legal Aid society or advocate group by checking the yellow pages under "lawyers".

You have the right to review your case record. Upon your request, you have the right to free copies of documents that your local Department of Social Services presents into evidence at the fair hearing. Also, upon request, you have the right to free copies of other documents from your case record that you need for your fair hearing. To request such documents or to find out how you may review your case record, contact your local social services district at <http://otda.ny.gov/programs/heap/contacts>.

If you need someone who speaks Spanish, contact the NYS OTDA Hotline at 1-800-342-3009.

OTHER PROGRAMS YOU MAY BE ELIGIBLE FOR:

WEATHERIZATION ASSISTANCE

You may also be eligible for weatherization assistance programs through NYS Homes and Community Renewal (HCR) or the New York State Energy Research and Development Authority (NYSERDA). A list of local weatherization sub-grantee contacts can be found at: <http://hcr.ny.gov/weatherization-providers>. For more information on available NYSERDA energy services, visit <http://www.nyserda.ny.gov>. Your signature on the HEAP application allows a referral and exchange of information to be made to the weatherization assistance programs on your behalf.

UTILITY LOW INCOME PROGRAM

You may also be eligible to enroll in your utility company's low income program. Your signature on the HEAP application allows a referral to be made to your utility company on your behalf.

TYPES OF ACCEPTABLE DOCUMENTATION

RESIDENCE (Where you now live)

- Current rent receipt with name and address of tenant and landlord or lease with name and address
- Water, sewage, or tax bill
- Homeowner's/Renter's Insurance Policy
- Utility bill
- Mortgage payment books/receipts with address

IDENTITY

You must provide one or more of the following for each person in your household:

- Driver's License
- Photo ID
- US Passport or Naturalization Certificate
- Birth Certificate or Baptismal Certificate*
- Validated Social Security Number*
- Adoption Papers
- Hospital or Doctor's Records
- School Records
- Statement from another person*

***Two forms of proof required.**

SOCIAL SECURITY NUMBER

You must provide a valid Social Security Number for each member of your household. If you or a member of your household does not have a Social Security Number, you must apply for one at the Social Security Administration.

VULNERABILITY

You must provide one of the following for proof of vulnerability for a vulnerable member of your household (children under 6 years of age, adults 60 years of age or older, or anyone with a disability):

- Birth certificate
- Baptismal certificate with date of birth
- SSA Award letter
- Passport
- Driver's license
- Written statement of eligibility for benefits

HEATING SITUATION

If you pay a fuel or utility bill, provide a copy of your most recent fuel/utility bill or a statement from your vendor.

If you do not pay for heat, provide a current rent receipt with name and address of tenant and landlord, lease with name and address, or statement from your landlord that indicates heat is included in your rent.

INCOME

- Pay stubs for the most recent four (4) weeks
- If self-employed, business records for the most recent three (3) months or your filed federal tax return for the current year, including all applicable schedules.
- Rental income/expenses for previous three (3) months or your filed federal tax return for the current year, including all applicable schedules.
- Child support or alimony/spousal support
- Interest/Bank/Dividend or Tax Statement
- Statement from roomer/boarder

COPY OF AWARD LETTER OR OFFICIAL CORRESPONDANCE FOR THE FOLLOWING:

- Social Security/Supplemental Security Income (SSI)
- Veteran's Benefits
- Pensions
- Worker's Compensation/Disability
- Unemployment Insurance Benefits

RESOURCES (For emergency benefit applications only)

- Cash
- Stocks/bonds
- Checking, savings, and/or CD account balances
- Annuity
- IRA accounts
- Lump sums from sale of property or insurance settlements.

Applications for Heating Equipment Repair and Replacement require additional documentation. If you are applying for this component, you will be given a separate list of documentation you need to provide.